Medicinal plants for diabetes

Fenugreek seeds at levels of 15g per day lowers blood glucose level. Bittergourd and Jamun (Naval) exhibit hypoglycemic effect.

Food Exchange System

The food exchange system is a familiar tool to distribute the food in a balanced pattern. In this system, foods providing the same amount of calories, carbohydrate, proteins and fats are grouped together. The exchange list helps to interchange foods from the different food groups according to one's personal choice and preferences. e.g In a cereal exchange.

Idli - 1½ nos / Dosa -1 no / Chappathi - 1 no / Upma - ½ katori

Provide approximately 100 kilocalories. Similarly vegetable , fruit, pulse exchange are available.

Artificial sweeteners

People with diabetes can use artificial sweeteners instead of sugar but limiting their usage in beverages is considered safe.



Case Study

Raman is a 45 year old busy executive. He is obese, chronic smoker and physically inactive. His blood sugar levels are fluctuating.

What advice you would give him to maintain the blood glucose levels?

B. Exercise

Regular, moderate intensity exercise like brisk walking helps to control blood sugar and reduce the risk of cardio vascular diseases.

Benefits:

- Aids weight loss/ maintenance
- Improves blood lipid levels
- Increase blood pressure
- Improves blood glucose control

C. Drugs

Drugs to treat diabetes include insulin and oral hypoglycemic drugs.

People with type 1 diabetes need to take daily insulin injections.

Type 2 diabetes may respond to treatment with exercise, diet, and medicines orally. Some people with type 2 diabetes may no longer need medication. Individuals with type 2 diabetes also may require insulin under certain circumstances.

D. Education

Education plays a vital role in the control and management of diabetes. Individuals with diabetes should be educated on the nature of the disease, importance of diet, drug and exercise, self monitoring of glucose, recognition and treatment signs of hypoglycaemia and the possibility of complications if blood sugar is not kept under control.